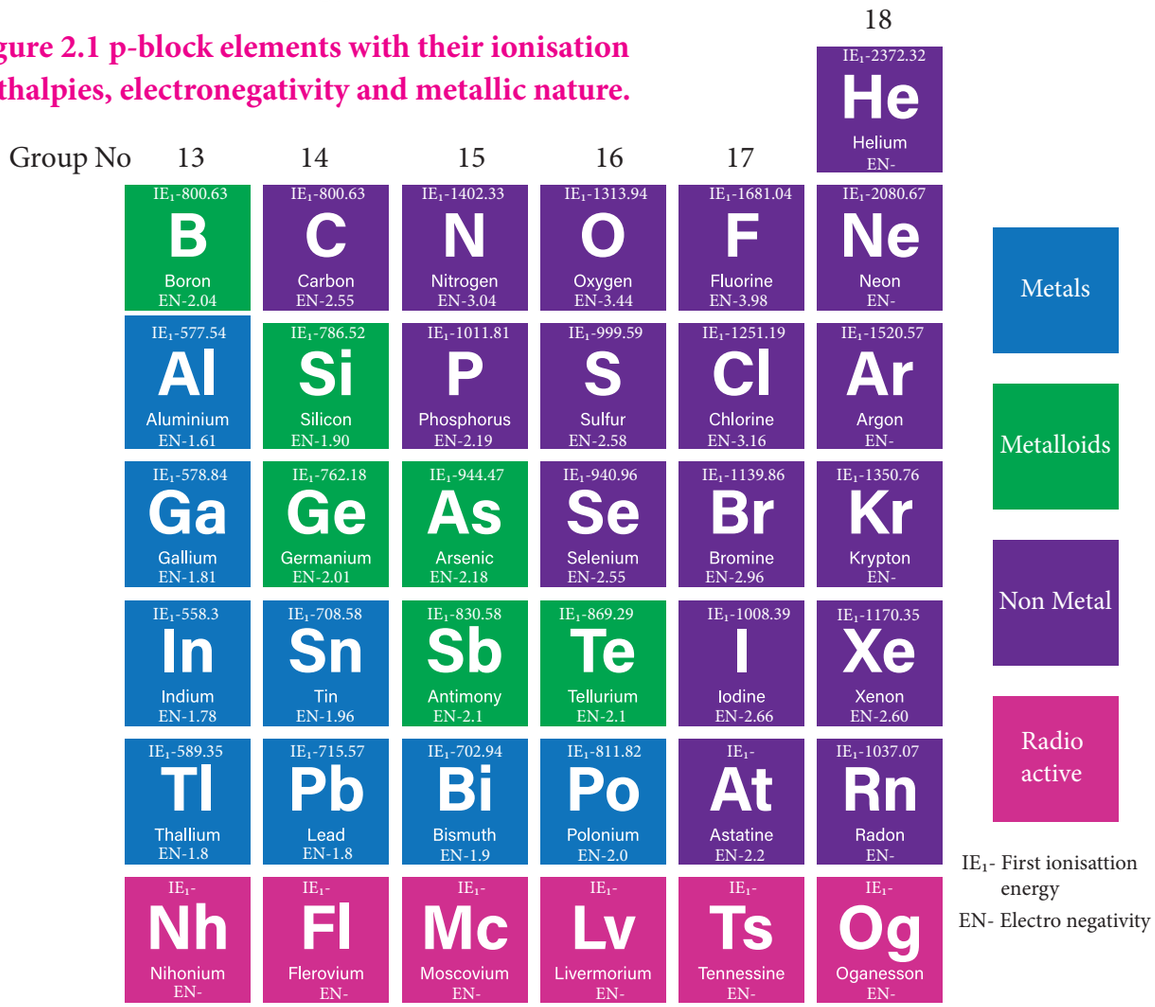
Table 2.1 General electronic configurations and oxidation states of p-block elements

Group No.	13	14	15	16	17	18
Group Name	Icosagens	Tetragens	Pnictogens	Chalcogens	Halogens	Inert gases
General outer electronic configuration	$ns^2\ np^1$	$ns^2\ np^2$	$ns^2\ np^3$	$ns^2\ np^4$	$ns^2\ np^5$	$ns^2\ np^6$
Highest oxidation state (Group oxidation state)	+3	+4	+5	+6	+7	+8
Other observed oxidation states	+1	+2, -4	+3, -3	+4, +2, -2	+5, +3, +1, -1	+6. +4, +2

2.1.2 Metallic nature:

The tendency of an element to form a cation by loosing electrons is known as electropositive or metallic character. This character depends on the ionisation energy. Generally on descending a group the ionisation energy decreases and hence the metallic character increases.

Figure 2.1 p-block elements with their ionisation enthalpies, electronegativity and metallic nature.



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